

INDONESIA

With a tropical climate and volcanic soil, Indonesia is conducive to tea cultivation, producing an average of 157,000 tons per year. It is best known for its dark and rich black teas.

The Dutch first planted var. *sinensis* seeds in Indonesia in 1684. However, this variety failed to flourish, and in the mid-1800s, they found that var. *assamica* was more suited to Indonesia's tropical climate. In the late 19th century, the first batch of black tea was shipped to Europe. Tea production thrived for several decades, but declined during World War II, when the Japanese occupied

the islands. The tea gardens fell into disrepair and did not recover, but in the late 1980s, a revitalization program initiated by the government helped to revive tea production. Tea now accounts for 17 percent of Indonesia's agricultural output. Although Indonesia produces some good oolongs and greens, it has always been best known for its full-bodied black teas.



NORTH SUMATRA

There are some tea gardens in North Sumatra that use the CTC method (see p21) to produce commercial tea, which is exported for the blending and tea bag industries.

JAVA

The best tea, manufactured using the orthodox method of production, is grown on the island of Java at an altitude of 2,500–5,000ft (700–1,500m). There are several plantations and small gardens in East Java, Banten, and near Bogor.

KEY



NOTABLE TEA-PRODUCING REGIONS



AREA OF PRODUCTION

INDONESIA KEY FACTS

PERCENTAGE
OF WORLD
PRODUCTION:

3.2%

ELEVATION:
HIGH

HARVEST: YEAR-ROUND, BUT SOME OF THE BEST TEAS ARE PICKED IN

JULY-SEPTEMBER

MAIN TYPES: BLACK, OOLONG, GREEN